Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Words in use

Language focus

Complete the sentences with the words below. Change the form if necessary.

adolescence	analogy	burgeoning	intervene
outweigh	nationality	suppress	trim

1. A useful _analogy_ is to imagine that the prefrontal cortex is the brain's remote control.
2. Studies show that early _intervention_ can significantly reduce delinquent behavior.
3. Modern neuroscience has demonstrated that emotion and _rationality_ are two inseparably linked components of all that we think and do.
4. Watching television more than two hours a day early in life can lead to attention problems later in _adolescence_, according to a study published on *Neuroscience*.

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Words in use

Language focus

Complete the sentences with the words below. Change the form if necessary.

adolescence	analogy	burgeoning	intervene
outweigh	nationality	suppress	trim

5. Leaving home at an early age, the boy learned to __suppress__ his emotions—and sometimes it may seem that he learned to have no emotions at all.

6. In whatever situations, the comfort of an employer ought not to __outweigh__ justice to an employee.

7. It was reported that China held more than 11,000 exhibitions in 2019, seeing a(n) __burgeoning__ exhibition economy.

8. Dead branches are __trimmed__ off the trees in case that they may fall and hurt the pedestrians passing by.

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Translation

Language focus

Translate the following sentences into Chinese. Pay attention to the words in bold.

1. As teens are so impressionable (易受影响的), the concern is that their opinions might be too easily swayed by others and **override** their decision-making.

   鉴于青少年易受外界影响，令人担心的是，他们的想法可能极易受他人左右，从而影响到自己的决定。

2. Most of us, as adults, no longer find many of the experiences we enjoyed as teenagers as pleasurable as we once did, and those of us who still do are better able to resist these **temptations** when we know we ought to.

   对于大部分人来说，青少年时期喜欢做的许多事情，成年之后再做，便不再像以前那般愉悦。那些仍能以之为乐的人，在应该抵制诱惑的时候，反而更能抵住这些诱惑。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Translation

Language focus

3. Finding her teenagers' **erratic** behavior increasingly demanding, the neurologist decided to study teenage thought processes and gather her research in a book.

这位神经学家发现，自己家的青少年的古怪举止越来越令人头疼，于是她决定研究青少年的思维过程，并将研究成果汇编成一本书。

4. Studies have shown remarkable changes that occur in the brain during the teen years, **coinciding** with what every parent can confirm: the teenage brain is a very complicated and dynamic arena (领域), one that is not easily understood.

有研究表明，青少年时期大脑会发生显著变化，这一点与每一位父母都能证实的事实一致：青少年的大脑是一个非常复杂和动态的领域，一个不容易理解的领域。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Translation

Language focus

5. Beginning at puberty (青春期), the brain is reshaped. Neurons (神经元) and synapses—**junctions** between neurons—burgeon in the cerebral cortex (大脑皮层) and are then gradually pruned throughout adolescence. Eventually, more than 40% of all synapses are eliminated, largely in the frontal lobes (额叶).

从青春期开始，大脑被重塑。神经元和作为神经元之间接点的突触，在大脑皮层中激增，然后在整个青少年时期被逐渐修剪。最终，40%以上的突触被剪除，它们主要分布在大脑前额叶。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

01

They are expected to make decisions that will profoundly affect the rest of their lives at a time when they seem particularly incapable of rationality—often throwing themselves headlong into dangerous or risky situations. **(Para. 1)**

此句破折号之前的半句中， that 引导定语从句that will profoundly affect the rest of their lives修饰decisions，说明要做出的决定影响深远，at a time when … rationality在前半句中作状语，表示做出决定的时间，其中when引导的定语从句修饰time，具体描述这一时期的特点，即青少年似乎非常难以保持理性的阶段；破折号之后的半句是现在分词短语throwing … 作结果状语，对前半句进行补充说明。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

02

During childhood, we accumulate an overabundance of synapses, and as we move into adolescence over half are systematically removed, while others are strengthened in order to make communication more efficient—a process known in neuroscience as “synaptic pruning.” **(Para. 2)**

此句中，over half指代over half of the synapses，others 指代other synapses；过去分词短语known in neuroscience … 作定语修饰process。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

03

However, the ability of teenagers to make rational decisions is overridden by the rush of dopamine—the hormone which triggers feelings of happiness—that occurs when they take risks. **(Para. 3)**

此句为主谓宾结构the ability of teenagers to make rational decisions is overridden by the rush of dopamine，谓语为被动语态，主语the ability of teenagers to make rational decisions较长，其中动词不定式短语to make rational decisions作定语修饰ability，表示做出理性决策的能力；两个破折号中间的部分the hormone which … happiness是一个插入语，用来解释说明dopamine；that引导的定语从句修饰the rush of dopamine，表明多巴胺激增在冒险的情况下会发生。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

04

When no emotional information was present (i.e. the facial expression was neutral), teenagers performed as well as adults, if not better. (Para. 4)

此句为主从复合句。主句teenagers performed as well as adults, if not better中，if not的意思是to suggest that sth. may be even larger, more important, etc. than was first stated，表示相比于前者，后者可能更大或更重要等，所以主句等同于teenagers performed as well as adults; they may perform even better than adults，青少年的表现和成年人一样好，甚至可能比成年人更好。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

05

While this may be true in heated or stressful situations, perhaps because they tend to rely on the amygdala—the part of the brain that guides instinct—rather than the prefrontal cortex, in neutral situations adolescents are actually better equipped to control impulses and make rational decisions than adults. (Para. 4)

此句为主从复合句，较为复杂。主句in neutral situations adolescents … than adults，主语为adolescents，与more than比较结构中的adults相对应；while引导的让步状语从句较长，其中because引导的原因状语从句对this may be true in heated or stressful situations进行解释，说明“青少年总是无法理性行事或做出正确的决定”这种说法在面临激烈或紧张的情况时可能是正确的，原因是青少年倾向于依赖杏仁核（the amygdala）而非依赖前额叶皮质（the prefrontal cortex）来做决定，the amygdala与the prefrontal cortex对应，两个破折号之间的插入语是对amygdala含义的解释；in heated or stressful situations与主句中in neutral situations对应，对比青少年在两种情况下的不同行为。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

06

It's also worth considering that while adolescent brains may still be in development, our ability to plan and recall events, as well as task coordination actually begins to decline fairly rapidly in our mid to late twenties. (Para. 5)

此句的真正主语为that引导的从句that while adolescent brains … to late twenties，为避免句子头重脚轻，it作为形式主语置于句首。而该主语从句中又包括一个由while引导的让步状语从句，主句的主语为our ability to plan and recall events和task coordination，由as well as连接。在A as well as B这一结构中，谓语动词的形式与as well as前面的主语即A的单复数保持一致，因此在这个句子中，主语our ability为单数，谓语动词用begins。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

07

Yet, perhaps this increased propensity for risk-taking should be seen as beneficial as it is undoubtedly one of the factors that drive adolescents to seek out the kind of new experiences that might shape their careers. **(Para. 6)**

此句为主从复合句，结构较为复杂。主句为perhaps this increased propensity for risk-taking should be seen as beneficial，后接as引导的原因状语从句as it is undoubtedly … shape their careers。先来看主句，主语this increased propensity for risk-taking，谓语为被动语态should be seen as，其中(sth.) be seen as … 为固定搭配，表示“（某事）被看待为……；（某事）被认为是……”，它后面由as引导的原因状语从句则解释了这句话的原因。接着我们再来看从句，在这个状语从句中，句子主体为主系表结构it is undoubtedly one of the factors，主语it指代this increased propensity for risk-taking，that引导的定语从句that drive adolescents … their careers修饰one of the factors，用来解释究竟是什么样的因素。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

08

Having said that, it could also be argued that as the brain is still in development during this period, key decisions should be delayed until later life—when we are better able to balance risk and logical decision-making more effectively. (Para. 6)

现在分词短语Having said that起承接上句的作用，表转折，意思是“话虽如此”，其中that指代上句。it为本句形式主语，真正的主语为that引导的从句that as the brain … more effectively。在该从句中，又包括一个由as引导的原因状语从句，主句为key decisions should be … more effectively，其中破折号后面是由when引导的定语从句修饰later life，说明推迟到的时间究竟是什么时候，即“我们能更有效地权衡风险、做出理性决策的时候”。

Reading 2

Reading & understanding

Difficult sentences

Language points

09

Given that the desire to seek out risk and short-term rewards is so strong, this is perhaps not the best time to make decisions that will profoundly affect the rest of our lives. **(Para. 6)**

此句中，given that … 意为 taking … into consideration, considering“考虑到……”，此处用于引导条件状语从句；在主句中，that引导的定语从句修饰decisions，说明这些决定将对余生产生深刻的影响。